

HAMID RAFIQUE

aka Cindrix

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EDUCATION

BS Cyber Security

Air University (NCSA), Islamabad

Sep 2025 – Oct 2029 (Expected)

3rd Semester · CGPA 3.15/4.0

2nd Sem GPA: 3.22

CERTIFICATIONS

- ISO/IEC 27001:2022 Info. Security Associate — SkillFront
- Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate
- DataCamp: Python, OOP, Git/GitHub, Bash, AI & Data Literacy (9 tracks)

CORE SKILLS

Offensive

Web Exploitation · SQLi · SSTI · Buffer Overflow / ret2win · RE · Weak ECDSA/RSA Attacks

Defensive

SIEM Fundamentals · IR Workflows · NIST RMF · Log-Based Detection

Tooling

Burp Suite · Metasploit · Nmap · Wireshark · Splunk/ELK · gdb · pwntools

Languages

Python · C++ (OOP) · Bash · JavaScript/HTML/CSS

Platform

Kali Linux · Git/GitHub · Firebase

Blue Team / SOC Aspirant · Competitive CTF Player · Builder

Cybersecurity undergraduate at Air University's National Cyber Security Academy, building toward blue team and SOC analyst work while staying sharp offensively through competitive CTF play. Designed and shipped a custom CTF platform used by ~94 students, co-authored a research paper on Windows persistence attacks, and is working through a 10-project self-directed SOC detection portfolio.

FLAGSHIP PROJECT

Fractured Signal — Custom CTF Platform

Air University

Firebase · GitHub Pages · Student Whitelist Auth

- ▶ Designed and deployed a full CTF platform used by roughly 94 Air University students to practice offensive security skills in a controlled environment.
- ▶ Built a student whitelist registration system on a Firebase backend, hosted and continuously delivered via GitHub Pages.

COMPETITIVE CTF EXPERIENCE

CTF Player — Team Polyglot

2025 – Present

Alias: Cindrix · Air University E9 Campus, Islamabad

- ▶ Compete regularly in university and national-level CTFs across web exploitation, reverse engineering, cryptography, and binary exploitation.
- ▶ Placed 6th at Hack4Bug 2026, solving reverse-engineering and forensic log-analysis challenges.
- ▶ Solved a ret2win buffer-overflow challenge via a 40-byte offset payload using gdb and pwntools; cleared SQLi labs (incl. a WAF-bypass via XML encoding) on PortSwigger Web Security Academy.
- ▶ Captured flags via SSTI, session-cookie exploitation, and an arbitrary-function-call bug in a FlagYard PHP challenge.
- ▶ Competed in YECTF 2026 and TBCTF (OSINT, forensics, web, crypto, RE); solved OSM-based geolocation challenges with Overpass Turbo and Python/pandas.

RESEARCH

Co-Author — Windows System Resource Exhaustion & Stealth Persistence Attacks

Supervised by Sheikh Qaisar Ayyub · Co-authors: Wadia Sahar, Hashir Kamal Ahmed

- ▶ Researched and documented Windows persistence and resource-exhaustion attack techniques, informed by a hands-on C++ persistence-mechanism simulator built for coursework.

ACADEMIC PROJECTS

Security Analysis of Metasploitable 2 Using Tenable Nessus

Nov – Dec 2025

Kali Linux · Tenable Nessus Essentials · Introduction to Cyber Security Course

- ▶ Built a full penetration-testing lab and ran vulnerability scans identifying Critical/High/Medium/Low issues, including Telnet, VSFTPD 2.3.4, and NFS misconfigurations.
- ▶ Ethically exploited findings to demonstrate unauthorized access, then applied and verified remediation (service removal, patching, NFS hardening).

Persistence Mechanism Simulator (C++)

Nov – Dec 2025

Programming Fundamentals Course

- ▶ Built an educational simulator modeling malware persistence — repeated execution, state retention, conditional re-launching — to study attack patterns defensively.

ICT Quiz Website

Nov – Dec 2025

HTML5 · CSS3 · Vanilla JavaScript · GitHub Pages

- ▶ Shipped a responsive quiz app with 6 timed subject tracks, local-storage history, and dark/light theming, deployed via GitHub Pages CI.

IN PROGRESS

- ▶ SOC Detection Portfolio — 10-project sequence spanning brute-force/port-scan/reverse-shell detection, log-based IDS, beaconing detection, and SIEM web-attack detection (Splunk/ELK, Kali, Wireshark).
- ▶ Bug bounty hunting — scoping first live submissions on HackerOne.